Keep track of the change

CodeRabbit Change Stack | Formbricks #8650 | Parth Pawar

Make Change Stack easier to review without losing what it can do. I focused on three decisions: read before navigating, inspect and return, and mark progress deliberately. My assumption: keeping the layer, file, explanation and review state together takes extra effort.

What I noticed	What I chose, and why
Summary points share a broad range. Expanding also moves the code.	Expand the full summary in place. Browse summaries reaches another explanation without moving code. Line links inspect individual statements; the whole function stays available.
Layers and files are separate. Following a guard leaves a return trip to remember.	Nest files under their layer. Inspect guard opens the dependency; Return restores the caller and position. This keeps one wide code pane; a side-by-side option would need more horizontal space.
Seen, viewed and submitted mean different things.	The source already has seen and viewed controls. I added a file count and immediate Undo. Navigation leaves progress alone; summary seen and Submit keep their own meanings.
Supporting change: actions span several control groups.	Keep frequent file actions beside the filename and display controls beside the diff. Put secondary actions in Tools. That adds a click; I'd check whether people can find them.
Supporting change: file and layer totals need a clear scope.	Start with This file and keep Entire layer one click away. Counts follow the scope: access.ts has 3 messages; its layer has 15. The diff stays in place.

What I gave up

Context takes space from the diff; Focus gives it back. Precise highlights can distract from surrounding branches. Inspect + Return means switching views. Status-first comments need testing with open findings; this sample has one resolved thread.

What I kept

The header, merged state, layer order, counts, complexity labels, J/K and Focus remain. Comments retain their metadata and expand in place; a separate line link opens code. Gray marks selection; orange highlights linked code.

What I would test

Trace the workspace guard, explain its checks, return and mark the file viewed. Compare both versions, varying the order; note missed checks and lost position. Then try more dependencies and open findings. Check how new commits affect links and viewed progress.

Observations and assumptions from using this PR, not developer research. Seven of 52 diffs at commit 23cdac2; manually mapped links; one paraphrased finding, with two reply bodies omitted. Secondary workflows are previews. Submit is disabled for the merged PR. Work exceeded the 1–2 hour brief. Paper requires sign-in.

Paper design | Working prototype